

# **ANALYSIS OF CANADIAN GENERAL AVIATION, PILATUS PC-12 FLEET DYNAMICS, AND LEVAERO AVIATION INC. PILATUS AIRCRAFT HISTORY**

By: Nipun Jaiswal  
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## **1. Executive Summary**

This paper provides a comprehensive analysis of the Canadian general aviation landscape from 1999 to 2026, with a specific focus on the Pilatus PC-12 market and the historical registration footprint of Levaero Aviation.

The data reveals a resilient, steadily growing Canadian aviation market that is experiencing a distinct structural shift toward heavier, high utility aircraft. Recent macroeconomic catalysts, including US tariff shifts, have triggered an unprecedented surge in Canadian PC-12 registrations over the 2024-2025 period. Finally, this report reconciles a common data paradox within the Transport Canada Civil Aircraft Register regarding Levaero's market share, demonstrating how regulatory registration mechanics obscure Levaero's true reach as an exclusive distributor

This analysis is done in 3 parts

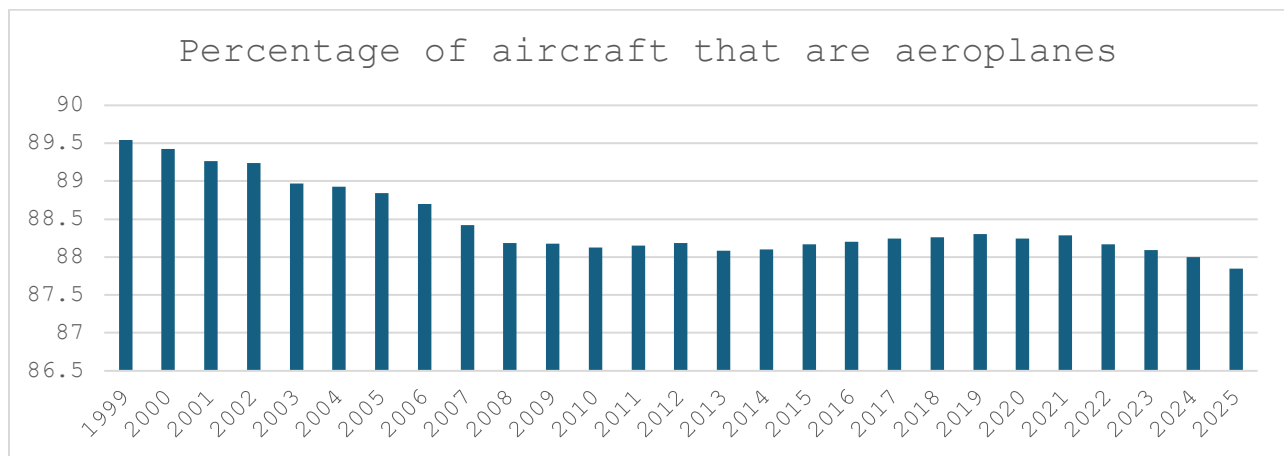
1. General Canadian aviation analysis
2. Analysis of overall registered PC-12's in Canada
3. Analysis of Levaero Aviation Inc. and it's former company names' activities in the Pilatus aircraft

## 2. General Canadian Aviation Trends (1999–2025)

The total number of registered aircraft in Canada grew **49.9%** over the analyzed period, expanding from 25,114 in 1999 to 37,654 in 2025, driven by population growth, tourism, and expanding corporate travel.

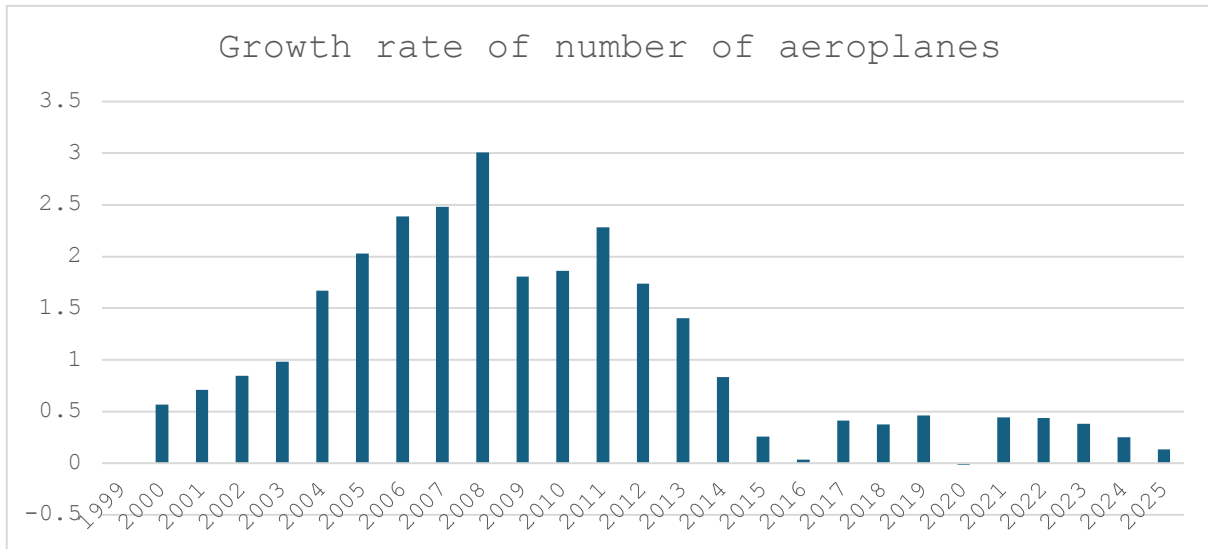
### Key Market Characteristics:

- **Aeroplane Dominance:** Fixed wing aeroplanes consistently command between **87% and 90%** of the entire Canadian registry, with helicopters, gliders, and balloons accounting for the remainder. ([Canada; \(2019\). CCAR Web - National Year-End Summaries.](#))



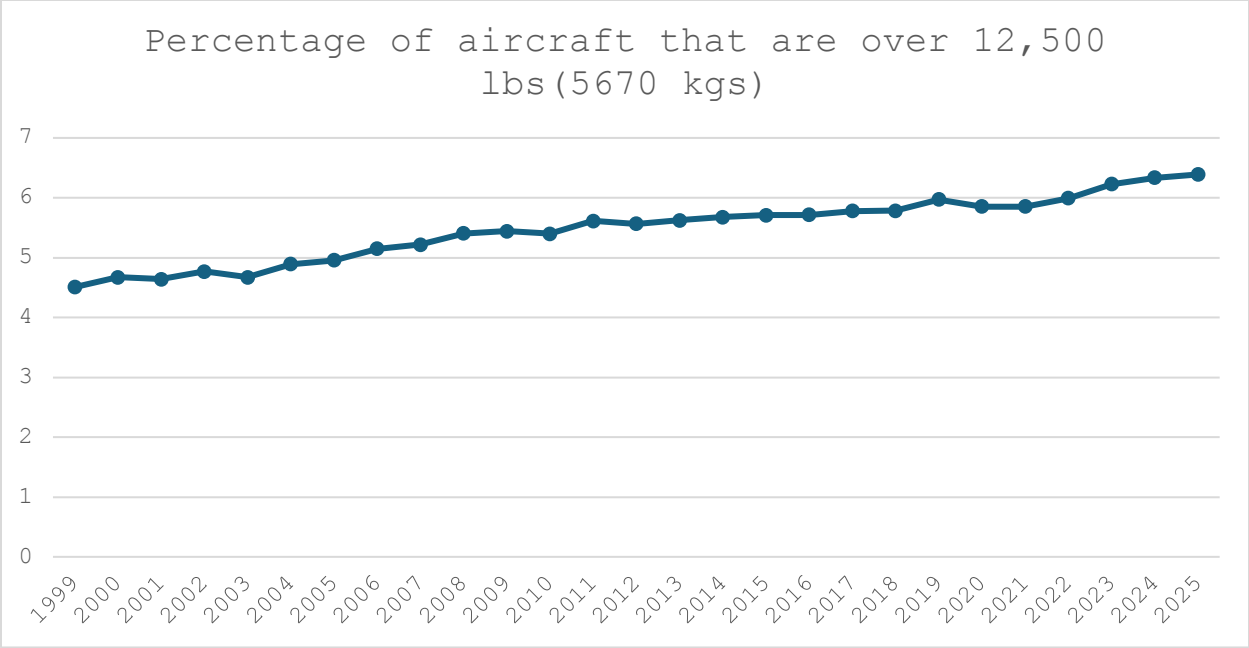
- **The 2020 Pandemic Anomaly:** Total aircraft growth has historically remained net positive every single year, with a singular exception in 2020. Due to COVID-19 disruptions, registrations contracted by **-0.012%** (dropping slightly from 32,541

to 32,537 units). Post pandemic recovery has remained conservative, with annual growth rates capping below **0.5%**.



- **Shift Toward Heavier Airframes:** While light aircraft still represent over 90% of the total fleet, their market share is on a long term downward trajectory.

Concurrently, heavier aircraft (exceeding 12,500 lbs) grew from **4.51% to 6.38%** of the registry, signaling a rising market demand for higher cargo capacity, longer range, and robust corporate utility



### 3. Pilatus PC-12 Fleet Analysis in Canada

The Pilatus PC-12 remains a premier, highly versatile single engine turboprop within the Canadian corporate and utility sectors. As of May 2026, there are **130 historically registered PC-12s** in Canada.

#### The 2024–2025 Registration Surge

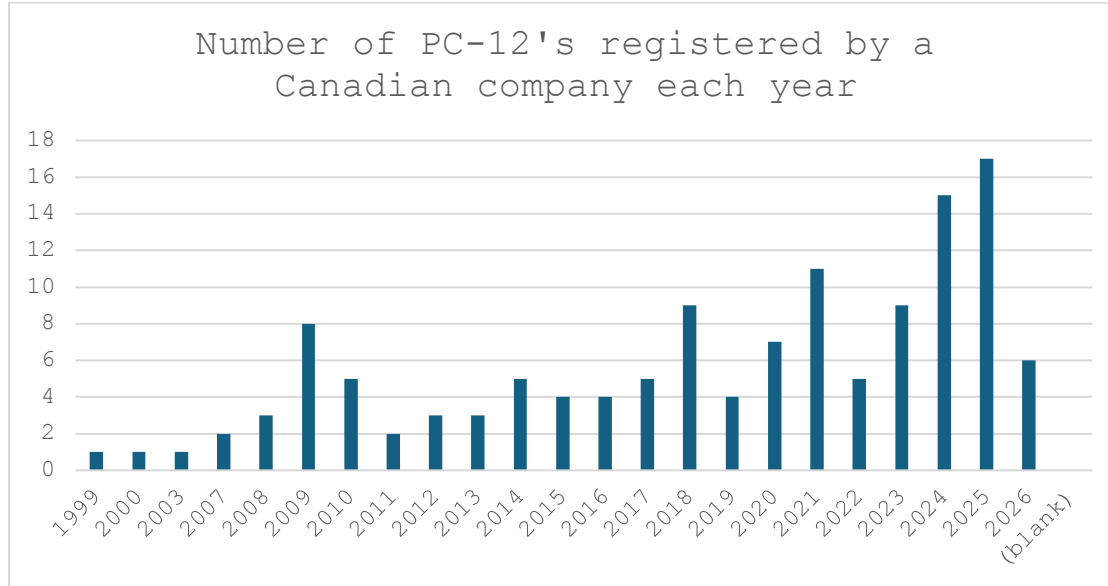
The Canadian market experienced an unprecedented spike in corporate PC-12 acquisitions over the last 24 months:

- **2024:** 15 units registered (the second highest historical year).
- **2025:** 17 units registered (the single highest registration year on record).

(Source: [Canada; \(2022\). CCAR Web - Quick Search Result. Tc.gc.ca.](#))

This sudden increase in the number of registered PC-12 aircraft among Canadian companies can be attributed to multiple reasons, including the US tariffs on Swiss manufactured goods, which led to Canadian buyers, backed by exclusive local dealer Levaero Aviation, to rapidly snap up and register available aircraft.

One can expect the number of registered PC-12'S by Canadian owners to grow as in late 2025, Pilatus officially secured its **Transport Canada type certification** for the brand new PC-12 PRO.

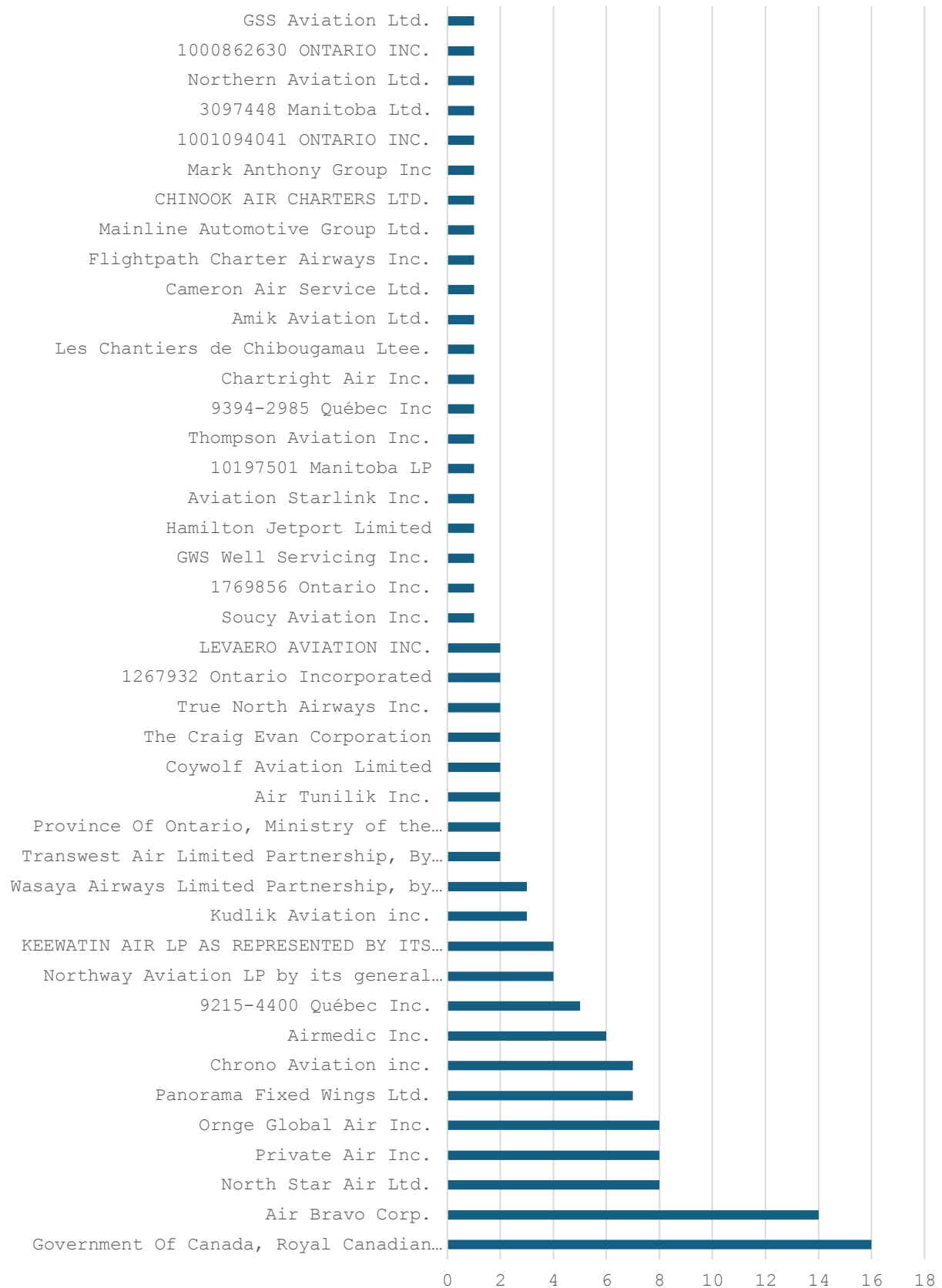


(Note: the date the data was collected is May 20<sup>th</sup> 2026, therefore the 2026 numbers are only up to that date and do not represent all of 2026)

### Notable Fleet Distribution:

- **Top Fleet Operator:** The Government of Canada (Royal Canadian Mounted Police) holds the largest single fleet footprint with 16 registered PC-12s, though they have not added a new unit to the register since January 21, 2014.
- **Future Outlook:** Continued fleet expansion is expected following Pilatus securing its Transport Canada type certification for the new **PC-12 PRO** in late 2025.

## Number of PC-12's registered per company in Canada



## 4. Evaluating Levaero's Footprint

A surface level query of the Transport Canada database shows only 2 PC-12s currently registered directly under *Levaero Aviation Inc.*, which superficially contradicts the company's status as Canada's exclusive distributor.

To solve this paradox, a historical data reconciliation was conducted across Levaero's three historical corporate entities over a 30 year lookback period:

1. V. Kelner Pilatus Center Inc.
2. Pilatus PC-12 Centre Canada Inc.
3. Levaero Aviation Inc.

### Historical Registry Breakdown:

| Metric                                                                           | Aircraft Count |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Total Unique PC-12s Ever Registered (under all 3 corporate names)                | 80 units       |
| Active Registrations Remaining Today                                             | 40 units       |
| — Active & Operating under other corporate/private names<br>(Distributed/Leased) | 38 units       |
| — Active & Currently held in Levaero inventory                                   | 2 units        |
| Historical Registrations Deleted/Exported from Canadian Registry                 | 15 units       |

(Source: [Canada; \(2025\). CCAR Web - Historical Search. Tc.gc.ca](https://tc.gc.ca/ccar-web/historical-search). (search for each company name))

While the raw historical data proves Levaero has directly “touched” at least 38 (or 29.2%) of the 130 active Canadian PC-12s, even this 80 unit historical footprint understates Levaero's true market dominance.

**Why the data doesn't tell the whole story:** In standard brokerage and distribution operations, an exclusive distributor rarely takes operational "custody and control" of an aircraft during a direct factory to client transaction. Consequently, Transport Canada issues the initial Certificate of Registration directly in the end buyer's name, bypassing Levaero's corporate nomenclature entirely in public datasets. Therefore, using raw registry data alone to measure market share results in an artificially deflated calculation of distributor volume.

Additionally, Levaero's expansion into the PC-24 market is already visible, with 2 historical registrations, including a high profile placement with the Province of Ontario, Ministry of the Solicitor General

Sources:

Canada; (2019). *CCAR Web - National Year-End Summaries*. Tc.gc.ca.

<https://wwwapps.tc.gc.ca/Saf-Sec-Sur/2/CCARCS-RIACC/SmYACat.aspx>

Canada; (2025). *CCAR Web - Historical Search*. Tc.gc.ca.

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<https://wwwapps.tc.gc.ca/Saf-Sec-Sur/2/CCARCS-RIACC/RchSimpRes.aspx?cn=%7c%7c&mn=PC12%7c&sn=%7c%7c&on=%7c%7c&m=%7c%7c&rfr=RchSimp.aspx&print=y>